



Solution Guide: Removing Unnecessary Packages with PowerShell

For this exercise, we used conditionals in a PowerShell script to uninstall various Windows packages that add bloat to the system and increase its attack surface area.

Solution

1. Create a PowerShell script file called `removepackages.ps1` in the working directory.
 - Run `cd C:\Users\azadmin\Documents\Activity\choco`.
 - Create a `removepackages.ps1` file:
 - Create a file in your preferred text editor and save it as `removepackages.ps1`.
2. Import the CSV `chocoactivity.csv` by assigning the `$csv` variable to the `Import-Csv` cmdlet, with the appropriate parameters.
 - We'll need a line to import the CSV file:
 - Type `Import-Csv -Path ./chocoactivity.csv`.
3. Create a `foreach` condition where a `$package` variable reads each line in the `$csv` variable.
 - Start a PowerShell `foreach` loop template:

Unset

```
foreach () {  
  
}
```

- Construct the `foreach` condition within the parentheses.
 - Enter `$package in $csv` in the parentheses.
4. Within the code block, run the `uninstall` command with the appropriate variable and attribute.
- Enter `choco uninstall -y $package.name` in the code block.
1. For the bonus, add the following line: `Write-Output $package.name removed!`.
- Your final script should look like this:

Unset

```
$csv = Import-Csv -Path .\chocoactivity.csv
foreach ($package in $csv) {
    choco uninstall -y $package.name
    Write-Output $package.name removed!
}
```

When we successfully create and execute the script, PowerShell will start uninstalling the packages within the CSV file. This will take a few minutes to complete.
